TERCIER MARKET RESEARCH

Synthetic Buyer Survey Swiss Premium Hotels

272 real hotel dossiers. 1,632 simulated buyer interviews. Adversarial critique. Judge-calibrated findings.

Date: March 13, 2026

Methodology: 3 replications x 2 roles x 3-pass pipeline (interview + adversarial + judge)

Models: GPT-5-mini (interviews, adversarial) + GPT-5 (judge calibration)

Cohort: 272 ICP hotels (4-5 star, ADR >= CHF 250, enriched dossiers)

Methodology: What This Is (and Isn't)

What We Did

- Loaded **718 real Swiss hotel dossiers** with website-derived enrichment data (star rating, rooms, ADR, positioning, booking infrastructure, audience signals)
- Applied ICP filter: 4+ stars, ADR >= CHF 250, enriched website data. Result: **272 hotels**
- Simulated **2 buyer roles** per hotel: GM/Owner and Commercial/Marketing Director
- **3 independent replications** per hotel-role to measure consistency (1,632 total interviews)
- Each interview covers: problem salience (7 dimensions), Gabor-Granger pricing (6 price points), purchase justifiers, deal killers, proof requirements
- **Adversarial critic** pass to challenge optimistic assumptions
- **Judge pass** (GPT-5) for final calibration with strict confidence criteria
- Conservative merge of GM + Commercial perspectives per hotel

What This Is NOT

- Not real survey data. These are **synthetic respondents** grounded in real hotel characteristics
- Cannot capture actual internal politics, personal relationships, or hidden budget constraints
- Hotels with limited website data have less grounded responses
- Replication consistency was high (541/544 groups fully distinct), but some variance is expected

Data Quality Checks

- **541/544** hotel-role groups had fully distinct replications (no copy-paste)
- **272/272** hotels have segment + revenue data from enriched master CSV
- **0 slug mismatches** across all pipeline phases
- Deal killers canonicalized into 9 clean categories
- Judge confidence: 21% high, 63% medium, 17% low

> Treat these results as hypothesis-grade intelligence for outreach prioritization. Validate the top 10-20 targets with real discovery calls before committing to any pricing or go-to-market strategy.

Headline Numbers

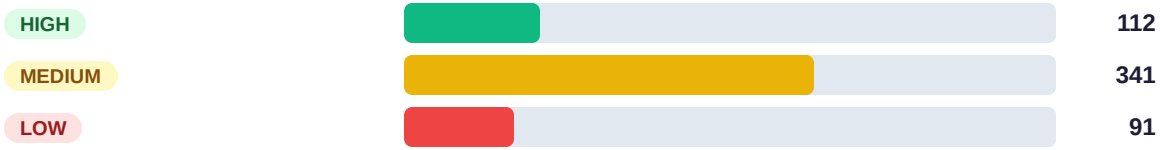
272 ICP HOTELS SURVEYED	**37%** AVG BUY LIKELIHOOD @ CHF 3K	**15%** AVG BUY LIKELIHOOD @ CHF 5K	**67%** AVG 12-MONTH DELAY RISK
CHF 2.4B TOTAL REVENUE POOL (ICP COHORT)	**89%** LAND IN CHF 1K-2K BAND	**79%** #1 BLOCKER: PMS INTEGRATION	**51** HIGHEST PRIORITY SCORE

The market is real but price-sensitive. 37% buy@3k drops to 15% at CHF 5k. Sweet spot: CHF 1k-2k/month. The 67% delay risk means ~33% are "buy now" candidates = ~90 hotels. At 37% buy likelihood = ~33 realistic near-term buyers. With 3-4 warm intros/month and a 4-8 week close = 15-25 hotels in year 1. This validates the business plan's 15-21 target.

Cohort Composition

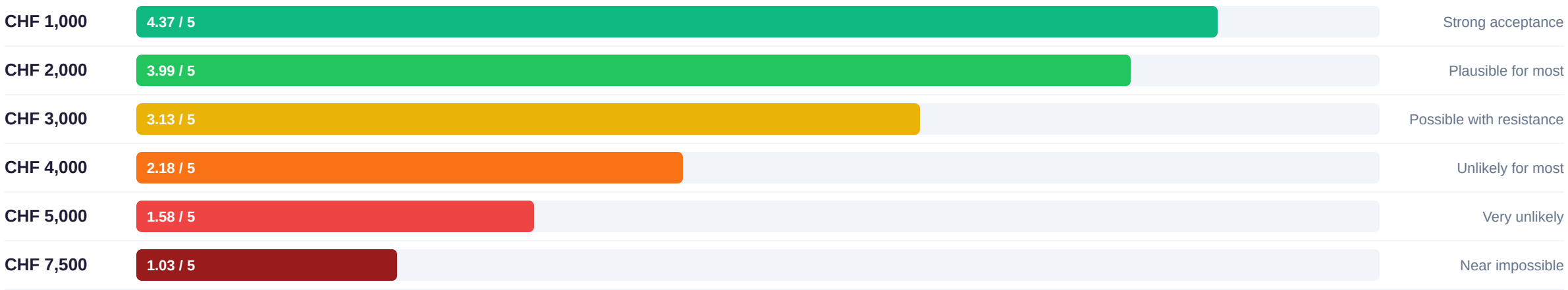
SEGMENT	HOTELS	AVG BUY@3K	AVG PRIORITY
Luxury (5-star)	97	40%	43
Upper Upscale (4-star premium)	164	35%	39
Business & Conference	6	40%	45
Upscale / Serviced Apartments	5	33%	33

Confidence Distribution (Judge)



Gabor-Granger Pricing Ladder

Average purchase consideration (1 = impossible, 5 = likely) across 1,632 interview responses

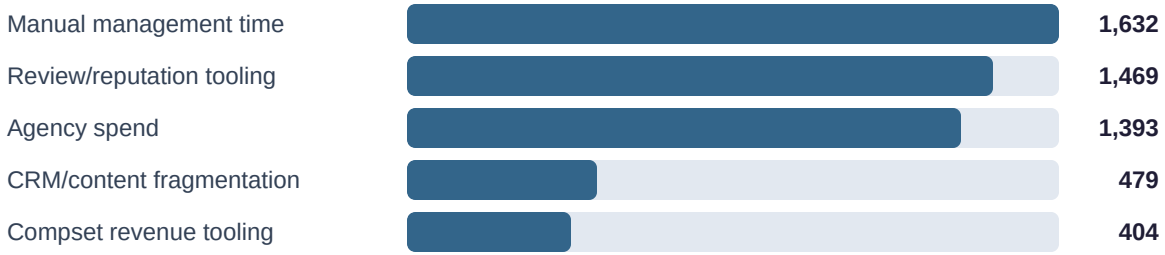


> Hard resistance kicks in around CHF 3,000. The cliff between CHF 2k (3.99) and CHF 3k (3.13) is the steepest drop in the ladder. CHF 5k is essentially a non-starter for initial contracts.

Recommended Price Bands (Judge-Calibrated)

*Small serviced apartments where CHF 3k+ SaaS economics don't work against CHF 3-5M revenue. Noise, not signal.

What Budget Would This Replace?



Top 10 Priority Targets

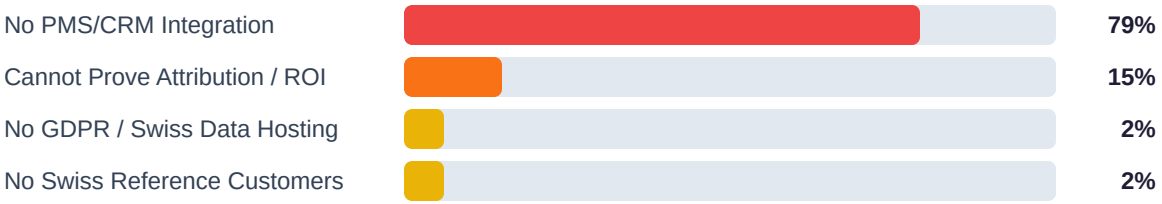
Priority score = buy@3k (35%) + buy@5k (25%) + inverse delay (20%) + revenue normalization (20%). Range: 14-51.

#	HOTEL	LOCATION	STARS	ROOMS	ADR (CHF)	REVENUE (CHF)	PRIORITY	BUY@3K	BUY@5K	DELAY
1	**Hotel Schweizerhof Zurich**	Zurich	5	95	784	18.4M	**51**	51%	28%	56%
2	**Hotel Suvretta House**	St. Moritz	5	176	780	34.1M	**51**	50%	27%	57%
3	**Victoria-Jungfrau Grand Hotel**	Interlaken	5	216	725	38.9M	**51**	48%	27%	55%
4	**Hotel Bellevue Palace**	Bern	5	126	434	13.6M	**50**	46%	25%	58%
5	**Hotel Schweizerhof Bern & Spa**	Bern	5	99	434	10.7M	**50**	47%	26%	57%
6	**AlpenGold Davos**	Davos Dorf	5	216	348	18.7M	**49**	47%	24%	60%
7	**Beau-Rivage Palace**	Lausanne	5	168	661	27.6M	**49**	48%	26%	58%
8	**Grand Hotel Les Trois Rois**	Basel	5	82	510	10.4M	**49**	48%	25%	59%
9	**Hotel Metropole Geneve**	Geneva	5	102	621	15.7M	**49**	47%	25%	58%
10	**Hotel Schweizerhof Luzern**	Luzern	5	101	388	9.7M	**49**	45%	24%	60%

Top targets are all 5-star, 80+ room urban or resort hotels with CHF 10M+ annual revenue. These have the budget capacity and operational complexity to justify Tercier. The top 3 all score 51 -- the pipeline's ceiling after adversarial critique and judge calibration.

What Kills the Deal

Top Deal Killers (Canonical Categories)



> PMS/CRM integration is the single dominant deal killer at 79%. This is not a nice-to-have -- it's table stakes. Without connecting to their PMS (Protel, Opera, Mews, etc.), the platform is a silo.

Proof Package Priority (Weighted Ranking)

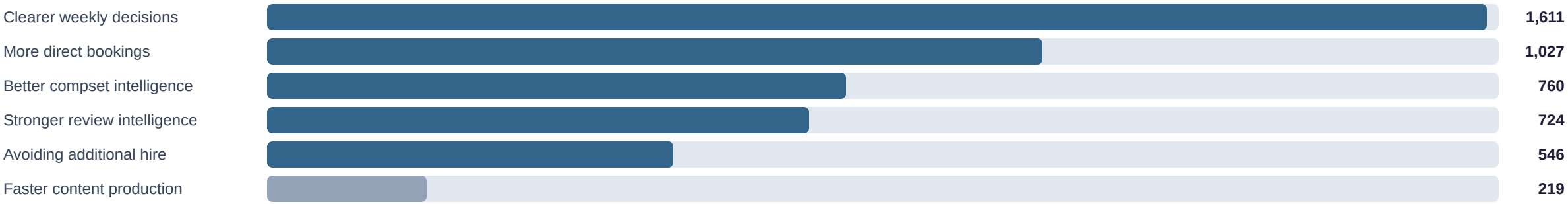
#	PROOF ITEM	SCORE
1	**PMS/CRM Integration**	1,089
2	Swiss Hotel Reference	752
3	60-Day Pilot	642
4	GDPR / Swiss Hosting	636
5	90-Day Pilot	351
6	Live Dashboard Demo	225
7	Luxury Hotel Reference	204

Budget Lane

BUDGET BUCKET	COUNT	%
Commercial/Revenue	729	45%
Marketing Software	562	34%
GM Discretionary	314	19%
Owner Exception	27	2%

Why They'd Buy: Purchase Justifiers

Each interview selected exactly 3 justifiers from 10 options. N = 1,632 selections across all interviews.



> "Clearer weekly decisions" dominates at 99% mention rate. This isn't about any single feature -- it's about the platform synthesizing scattered data into action. The second strongest justifier, "more direct bookings," confirms the revenue angle is the primary ROI story.

Problem Salience by Segment (1-5 scale)

PROBLEM	LUXURY	UPPER UPSCALE
Guest sentiment	4.3	4.1
Competitive positioning	4.1	3.9
AI discovery*	3.8	3.5
Small team operations	4.0	4.2
Data to actions	4.4	4.3

Role Differences

*AI discovery (2.93 avg) is the lowest-scoring problem today. But BCG/NYU shows 37% of travelers already use AI for trip planning. This is your moat-building layer: lead with "weekly actions" (4.90/5), build trust with compset intelligence (4.05/5), then introduce AI discovery as a premium differentiator once they're on the platform.

GM/Owners emphasize: compset intelligence, ROI attribution, budget justification to ownership

Commercial/Marketing emphasize: review intelligence, content production speed, avoiding new hires

All 272 hotels showed role disagreements in the merge phase -- this is expected and healthy. The conservative merge takes the lower buy likelihood and higher delay risk between the two roles.

Segment Analysis

Luxury (97 hotels)

40%	16%	43
BUY@3K	BUY@5K	AVG PRIORITY

- Highest willingness to pay, but also highest expectations
- All top 10 targets are in this segment
- PMS integration is even more critical (Opera/Protel dominance)
- Swiss/luxury references are a hard requirement
- Budget lane: 48% commercial/revenue, 32% marketing

Upper Upscale (164 hotels)

35%	14%	39
BUY@3K	BUY@5K	AVG PRIORITY

- Largest segment (60% of ICP). Volume opportunity
- More price-sensitive -- CHF 1k-2k is the realistic band
- Small team operations is the #1 pain point (4.2/5)
- "Avoiding additional hire" ranks higher than for luxury
- Budget lane: 42% commercial, 36% marketing software

Business & Conference (6 hotels) -- Highest Buy Likelihood

Despite the small sample, business/conference hotels show 40% buy@3k and the highest average priority (45). They have clearer attribution paths (event revenue, corporate contracts) and are more accustomed to technology platform spending. Worth oversampling in validation.

> Go-to-market implication: launch with luxury (higher ACV, stronger case studies) but volume will come from upper upscale at CHF 1,500-2,000/month. Business/conference is a sleeper segment worth exploring.

What Makes Tercier a No-Brainer

At CHF 3,000/month

3 Required Outcomes (most cited):

1. Measurable uplift in direct bookings/revenue within 90 days
2. Competitive intelligence that outperforms what they get from STR/OTA reports
3. Time savings equivalent to at least 1 FTE's weekly commercial admin

3 Required Capabilities:

1. Seamless PMS/CRM integration (no manual data entry)
2. Actionable weekly briefs (not just dashboards -- specific recommendations)
3. Multilingual content generation that matches the hotel's brand voice

The One-Slide Number:

"We'll prove a 5-10% direct booking uplift in 90 days, or you walk."

Max implementation: 14-21 days | Min proof: 3 months | ROI believers: GM + Revenue/Commercial Director

At CHF 5,000/month

Extra Value Required:

- Full revenue attribution tied to platform actions
- Proven ROI of 5-10x the subscription cost
- Performance-based pricing component (shared risk)
- Dedicated account manager / white-glove support

Non-Negotiables at CHF 5k:

- GDPR compliance + Swiss/EU data hosting
- Monthly opt-out (no annual lock-in at this price)
- Proven Swiss hotel references (same category)

Remaining Blockers:

- Owner/board approval required for this spend level
- Competing priorities (renovation, PMS migration, staff)
- Seasonal cash flow constraints

> The gap between CHF 3k and CHF 5k is not just price sensitivity -- it's a fundamentally different buyer conversation. At CHF 3k, you're selling operational efficiency to a commercial director. At CHF 5k, you're selling revenue attribution to an owner/board, and they need hard proof.

Recommendations and Next Steps

Pricing Strategy

1. **Launch at CHF 1,500-2,000/month.** 89% of the market lands in CHF 1k-2k. Don't fight the data.
2. **Expansion path to CHF 3k** after 90-day proof period with demonstrated ROI. Only 10% of the market accepts CHF 2k-3k upfront.
3. **CHF 5k+ is an enterprise play** for large properties (150+ rooms, CHF 20M+ revenue) only after multiple Swiss references exist.
4. **Performance component:** Consider 70% base + 30% performance at higher tiers to reduce perceived risk.

Go-to-Market Priority

1. **Validate top 10 with real calls.** These are all 5-star urban/resort hotels with 80+ rooms. If 3-4 convert to pilots, the research is validated.
2. **Build PMS integration first.** 79% say it's the deal killer. Without it, nothing else matters.
3. **Secure 2-3 Swiss references.** Second-highest proof requirement. Even paid pilots count.
4. **GDPR/Swiss hosting is table stakes.** Not a differentiator -- a prerequisite.

Sales Playbook Implications

- **Lead with "clearer weekly decisions"** -- the #1 justifier at 99% mention rate
- **Sell to Commercial Director first** (45% of budget comes from commercial/revenue). GM signs off but doesn't champion.
- **60-day pilot is the foot in the door.** Ranks #3 in proof requirements. Reduces commitment anxiety.
- **Replacement anchor:** "This replaces the 10 hours/week your team spends on manual competitive monitoring + review analysis"
- **Expect 12+ month sales cycles** for 67% of the market. Build pipeline accordingly.

What NOT to Do

- Don't lead with AI discovery/visibility -- it's where the market will be in 18 months, not where it is today. Build it as a moat, not a wedge.
- Don't price above CHF 2k for first contract without a reference in their exact segment
- Don't skip the adversarial findings: the 67% delay rate is real
- Don't treat this data as ground truth -- it's hypothesis-grade. Validate with real conversations.

Synthetic research. Validate with real conversations before scaling.

Target Selection: Where to Focus

2x2 Matrix: Segment x Hotel Size

	LARGE (80+ ROOMS)	SMALL (<80 ROOMS)
Luxury (5-star)	**44% buy@3k** n=36 | CHF 22.9M avg rev | 154 rooms	**37% buy@3k** n=61 | CHF 8.3M avg rev | 45 rooms
Upper Upscale (4-star)	**39% buy@3k** n=43 | CHF 11.3M avg rev | 127 rooms	**34% buy@3k** n=121 | CHF 4.4M avg rev | 43 rooms

> Large luxury hotels buy at 44% -- 10 percentage points higher than small upper upscale. All top 10 targets sit in this quadrant. Start here. The 121 small upper upscale hotels are volume, not value -- they close at lower rates and at CHF 1-1.5k, not 2-3k.

Star Rating Breakdown

Top Location Clusters

LOCATION	HOTELS	AVG BUY@3K
Lausanne	6	**42%**
St. Moritz	9	**41%**
Luzern	8	**39%**
Zurich	24	**38%**
Geneva	10	**38%**
Ascona	6	**38%**
Grindelwald	6	36%
Davos	5	36%
Zermatt	37	35%
Gstaad	7	35%
Crans-Montana	7	33%

Lausanne, St. Moritz, and Luzern over-index on buy likelihood. Zermatt has volume (37 hotels) but average willingness. Amedeo's warm network in Zurich (n=24, 38%) is the natural starting point.

Plan vs. Data: Strategic Adjustments

The synthetic survey confirms the business plan thesis but reshuffles priorities.

PLAN SAYS	DATA SAYS	ADJUSTMENT
7-layer orchestrated platform	"Weekly actions" scores 4.90/5	**Simplify the pitch.** Lead with the weekly action pack, not the architecture.
AI discovery is a key differentiator	AI discovery scores 2.93/5 (lowest)	**It's a moat, not a wedge.** Build it in, don't sell it up front. GMs don't feel this pain yet.
EUR 2,500-5,000 for I+C tier	Hard resistance above CHF 3k (3.13/5)	**Start at 1.5-2k, earn the upsell.** 89% land in CHF 1-2k band.
No PMS integration needed	79% say it's THE deal killer	**Build an integration story.** Even a roadmap + timeline de-risks.
Proof-of-value at EUR 1,000-1,500	CHF 1-2k band = 89% of hotels	**PoV pricing is validated.** The data backs the plan.
15-21 hotels by month 12	~33 near-term buyers in pool of 272	**Achievable with warm intros.** 3-4/month x 8 months x 50% close = 12-16.

The data validates the plan's target (15-21 hotels in year 1) and pricing strategy (CHF 1-2k entry). The key adjustment: lead with operational efficiency ("clearer weekly decisions"), not AI intelligence. Build PMS integration as a priority. The market is ready -- but on its terms, not ours.

One-line summary:

272 Swiss premium hotels were surveyed. 37% would consider buying at CHF 3k/month. The #1 thing they want is clearer weekly decisions. The #1 thing that kills the deal is no PMS integration. Start at CHF 1.5-2k, prove ROI in 90 days, and expand from there. The math works: 33 near-term buyers, 15-25 realistic closes in year 1.